STEP-BY-STEP · ILLUSTRATED · BEGINNER FRIENDLY

Setting Up Your Stripe Account

Everything you need to go from "no account" to "ready to get paid," one screen at a time.

20–30 min
Typical time if you have your info ready (Page 2)

9 steps
Each step has a picture of what you'll see and what to type

$0
Stripe charges no fee to open an account; fees apply only when you get paid

WHAT IS STRIPE?

Stripe is the company that lets your business accept card payments (and Apple Pay, Google Pay, bank payments and more) on your website, through invoices, or through payment links. When a customer pays you, Stripe holds the money briefly, then deposits it into **your business bank account** automatically.

THE ROAD MAP

1–2
Create your login & verify your email

3–4
Start activation & describe your business

5–6
Your personal details & what customers see

7–8
Connect your bank & lock down your login

9
Review, submit, and you're live

> *"Go slowly and type everything exactly as it appears on your official documents. Most delays happen because a name, address or tax number doesn't match what the IRS or your bank has on file."*

Before you begin: about the pictures in this guide

The screen pictures in this guide are **simplified illustrations**, not real screenshots. Stripe updates its design often, so your screen may look a little different, with buttons in slightly different places or worded slightly differently. The **information it asks for stays the same**. If something looks different, look for the closest matching button or field.

DO THIS FIRST · 10 MINUTES

Gather Everything Before You Click Anything

Having this list on the table beside you is the single biggest time-saver.

What you need	Details & where to find it
An email address you check	Ideally your business email. Stripe sends your verification link and all important notices here.
A mobile phone	For a text-message code and to set up login security (Step 8).
Your business type	Are you a **sole proprietor / individual**, an **LLC**, a **corporation**, or a **nonprofit**? Check your formation papers or last tax return. Not sure? See Step 4.
Legal business name	Exactly as registered with the IRS (look on your EIN letter or tax return), e.g. "Smith Bakery LLC," not just "Smith's."
Tax ID number	**EIN** (9 digits, XX-XXXXXXX) if your business has one. Sole proprietors and many single-member LLCs can use their **Social Security Number**. Your latest W-9 or tax return shows which one your business uses.
Business address & phone	Where your business operates. A home address is fine for home-based businesses.
Your website or social page	Your website address. If you don't have one yet, a social media business page or a short description of what you sell works.
Your personal details	Legal first & last name, date of birth, home address, and your Social Security Number (Stripe usually asks for the last 4 digits first, and may ask for all 9).
Bank account for deposits	Either your online-banking login (fastest) **or** your 9-digit **routing number** and **account number**, found on a check or in your bank app. Use a business checking account if you have one.
Photo ID (just in case)	A valid, unexpired driver's license or passport. Stripe only asks for this if it can't confirm your identity automatically.
Owners' info (LLCs & corporations only)	Name, date of birth, address and SSN for anyone who owns 25% or more of the company.

Good to know

- You can **stop and come back** any time. Stripe saves your progress.
- Use a **laptop or desktop** if possible. It's easier to read and type.
- Use Chrome, Safari, Edge or Firefox, kept up to date.

Protect yourself

- Only type your info on pages whose address ends in **stripe.com** with the padlock icon.
- Stripe will **never** call, text or email asking for your password or codes.
- Never share your password, even with us.

STEP 1

Create Your Stripe Login

About 2 minutes

1. Open your web browser and type this address exactly: **dashboard.stripe.com/register**
2. **Email**: type the business email you want to use. 1
3. **Full name**: your first and last name. 2
4. **Country**: choose **United States** (or the country where your business is legally based). 3
5. **Password**: make it long (12+ characters) and **not used on any other site**. Write it down somewhere safe. 4
6. Click **Create account**. 5

Choose the country carefully

Once your account is activated, Stripe **does not let you change the country**. Picking the wrong one means starting over with a new account.

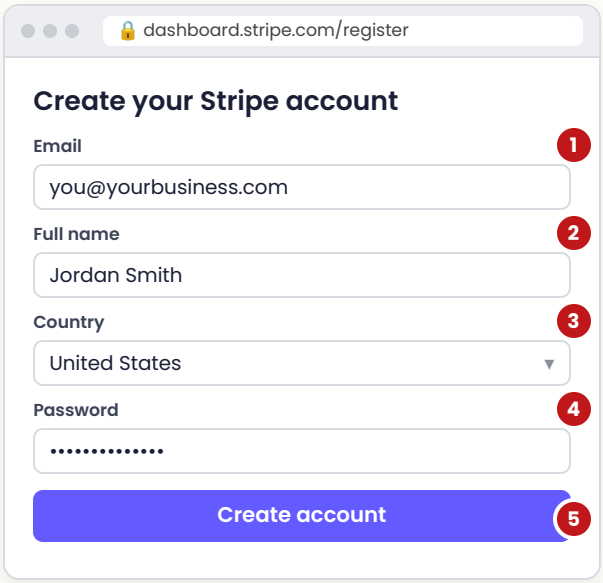


Illustration. Your screen may look slightly different.

STEP 2

Verify Your Email Address

About 1 minute

1. Open your email inbox (the same email you used in Step 1).
2. Find the email from **Stripe** asking you to verify your email address. Not there after 5 minutes? Check your **Spam**, **Junk** or **Promotions** folder.
3. Click the **Verify email address** button inside the email.
4. A browser tab opens and takes you to your Stripe **Dashboard** (your account's home screen). Keep this tab open for Step 3.

> *"Stripe may first ask a few quick questions about what you plan to do with Stripe. Answer them as best you can. You can't get them wrong, and you can skip any that don't apply."*

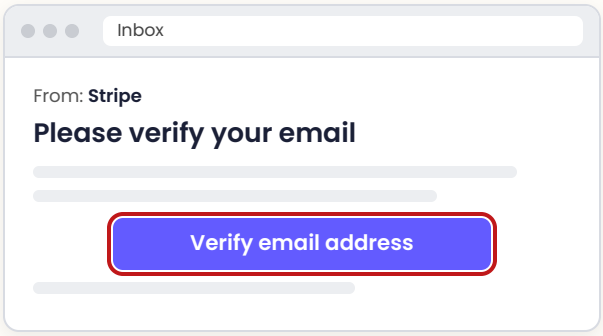


Illustration of the verification email.

STEP 3

Start Activating Your Account

About 1 minute

Your new account starts in **test mode** (a "sandbox"): you can look around, but can't accept real money yet. To turn on real payments, Stripe needs to verify your business.

1. On your Dashboard, look for a banner or button that says something like **Activate payments**, **Complete your profile** or **Verify your business**, and click it.
2. **Can't find it?** Type this address directly into your browser: **dashboard.stripe.com/account/onboarding**

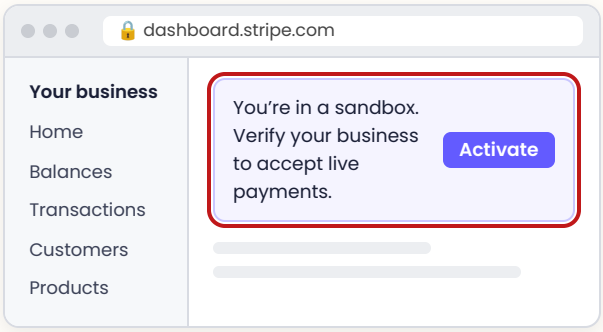


Illustration. Button wording varies.

"Next comes a short series of screens. Click Continue *at the bottom of each one."*

STEP 4

Tell Stripe About Your Business

About 5 minutes

A. Business location & type. Confirm your country and choose the option that matches how your business is legally set up:

If you are…	Choose
Just you, no LLC or corporation filed	**Individual / Sole proprietorship**
An LLC, S-Corp or C-Corp	**Company**, then pick your exact type
A registered 501(c) charity	**Nonprofit**

B. Business details. Enter your **legal business name**, **EIN** (or SSN if you're a sole proprietor), **business address** and **phone**.

C. Industry & website. Pick the closest industry, then enter your website. No website? Use your social media business page, or pick the no-website option and briefly describe what you sell.

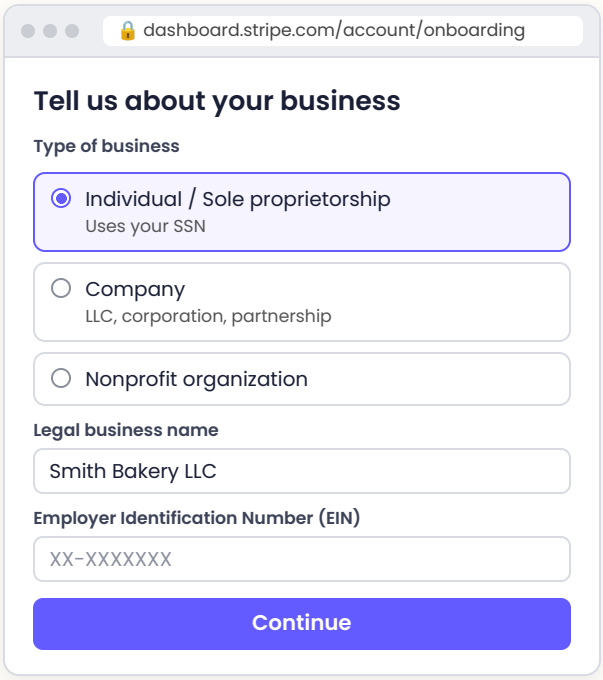


Illustration. Fields appear across one or more screens.

Must match the IRS exactly

Legal name + EIN must match your IRS records **letter for letter** (including "LLC" or "Inc."). A mismatch is the #1 reason verification gets stuck.

STEP 5

Verify Yourself (Personal Details)

About 3 minutes

By law ("Know Your Customer" rules), Stripe must confirm the real person behind every account. This information is **kept private** and is **not** shown to customers.

1. **Legal first and last name**, as on your driver's license.
2. **Email** and **job title** (e.g. Owner, CEO).
3. **Date of birth**.
4. **Home address**: your residential address, not a P.O. box.
5. **Phone number**.
6. **Last 4 digits of your SSN**. If Stripe can't match those, it will ask for the full 9 digits.

LLCs & corporations: one extra screen

Stripe asks you to confirm the **owners** (anyone with 25% or more) and leaders of the company. Add each person and their details, or confirm that you're the only one.

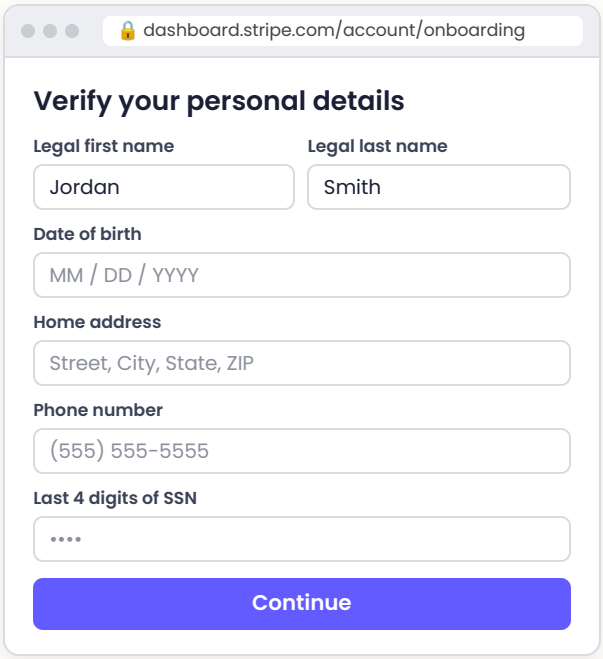


Illustration.

STEP 6

Set What Your Customers See

About 3 minutes

These **public details** appear on customers' card statements and Stripe email receipts. Clear details prevent "I don't recognize this charge" disputes.

1. **Statement descriptor**: the name printed on your customer's bank or card statement. Use the business name customers know you by.
2. **Shortened descriptor** (if asked): a 2–10 character short version of your name.
3. **Customer support phone**, **email** and **address**: where customers can reach you about a charge.

Statement descriptor rules

- 5 to 22 characters, using regular English letters
- At least one letter (not just numbers)
- Cannot use these symbols: **< > \ ' " ***
- Should match your business ("DBA") name

YOUR CUSTOMER'S CARD STATEMENT	
GROCERY MART #142	$64.18
SMITH BAKERY	**$38.00**
CITY GAS & FUEL	$41.07

The highlighted line is your statement descriptor.

Good vs. confusing

✓ **SMITH BAKERY** (customers instantly recognize it)

× **SB LLC 0042** (looks unfamiliar and invites disputes)

You may also see an optional climate-donation offer. It's fine to skip it.

STEP 7

Connect the Bank Account for Your Deposits

About 3 minutes

This is where Stripe sends your money. Stripe calls these deposits **payouts**. You have two choices:

Option A: Log in to your bank (fastest)

Search for your bank by name, then log in with your normal online-banking username and password through the secure pop-up window. Choose the checking account you want. It's verified instantly.

Option B: Enter numbers manually

Choose the manual-entry option and type your **routing number** (9 digits) and **account number**, then type the account number a second time to confirm.

Double-check every digit

Incorrect bank details are one of the most common reasons payouts are delayed. Use a **business checking** account in your business's name when you have one.

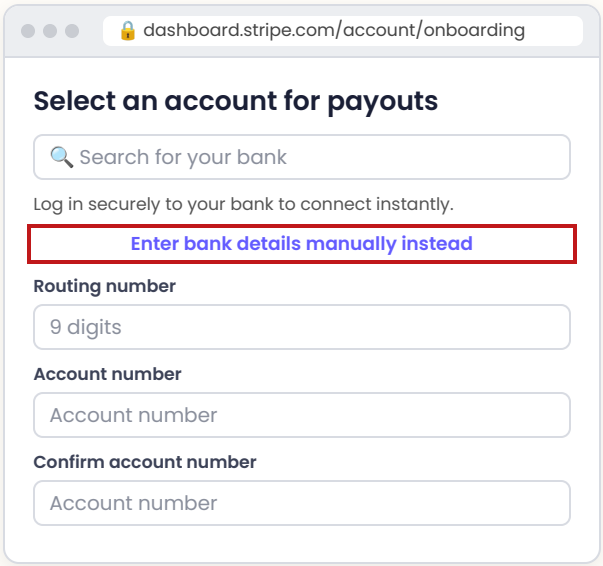
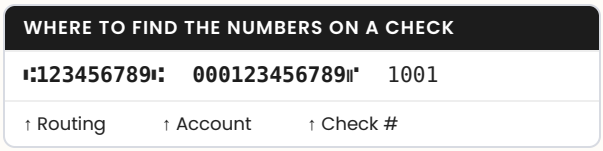


Illustration.



STEP 8

Turn On Two-Step Login Security

About 2 minutes

Two-step verification means that even if someone steals your password, they can't get into your account (or your money) without your phone or device. Stripe will ask you to set this up.

Method	Recommendation
Passkey (fingerprint / face on your device)	**Best.** Stripe recommends passkeys or security keys because they resist phishing.
Authenticator app	Great. Use Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, etc.
Text message (SMS)	Use only if nothing else works. Stripe calls it a last resort.

Save your backup code if Stripe shows you one. Write it on paper and store it somewhere safe. It's how you get back in if you lose your phone.

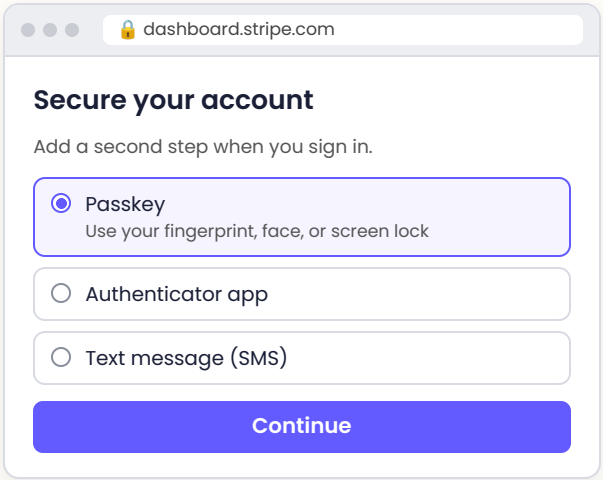


Illustration. You can add more methods later in Settings › Personal details.

STEP 9

Review Everything & Submit

About 2 minutes

1. Stripe shows a **summary page** with everything you entered. Read each section slowly.
2. Spot a mistake? Click **Edit** next to that section, fix it, and come back.
3. When everything is correct, click **Agree and submit**. This also accepts Stripe's Services Agreement.
4. Your Dashboard switches from test mode to **live mode**. You're ready to accept real payments.

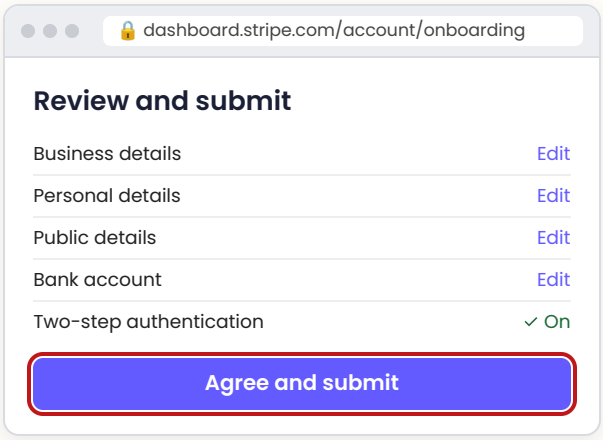


Illustration.

That's it, you did it!

Send us a quick text or call at **(678) 349-8808** once you've submitted, and we'll take it from there to connect Stripe to your website. **Never send us your password.** If we need access, Stripe lets you invite us as a team member (see the next page).

AFTER YOU SUBMIT

What Happens Next

Question	Answer
Can I accept payments right away?	Usually yes. Stripe reviews your information in the background and emails you if it needs anything else.
When does money reach my bank?	For US accounts, card payments typically become available in about **2 business days**, then are paid out to your bank automatically on a daily schedule by default. Some banks take an extra day to show the deposit, and certain business types can see longer timing.
What does Stripe cost?	No setup or monthly fee for standard payments. Stripe takes a small fee from each payment. See current rates at **stripe.com/pricing**.
Stripe emailed asking for more info. Is that bad?	No, it's normal. Common requests: a photo of your ID, your full SSN, or an IRS letter confirming your EIN (such as IRS Letter 147C or your SS-4 confirmation letter). Log in at **dashboard.stripe.com** (don't click links in unexpected emails) and follow the prompt.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Quick Fixes for Common Problems

Problem	What to do
No verification email	Wait 5 minutes, check Spam / Junk / Promotions, and confirm you typed your email correctly. You can request a new one from the Dashboard.
"We couldn't verify your business / tax ID"	Your legal name or EIN doesn't match IRS records. Compare against your IRS EIN letter, fix any difference (even "LLC" vs "L.L.C."), and resubmit.
"We couldn't verify your identity"	Re-check your legal name, date of birth, home address and SSN. Stripe may ask for your full SSN or a photo of your ID: use good lighting, no glare, all four corners showing.
Bank account won't connect	Use Option B (enter routing & account numbers manually). Confirm them in your bank app.
Locked out / lost phone	Use your backup code from Step 8, or use "Forgot password" on the Stripe sign-in page.
Need to give us access	In Stripe go to **Settings › Team and security › Team**, click **Add member**, enter our email, and choose the role we tell you. Never share your password.

TICK THESE OFF AS YOU GO

Your Setup Checklist

- ☐ **Gathered** everything on Page 2 (EIN or SSN, bank info, ID)
- ☐ **Step 1**: Created login at dashboard.stripe.com/register with the correct country
- ☐ **Step 2**: Clicked the verification link in my email
- ☐ **Step 3**: Clicked Activate / Verify your business on the Dashboard
- ☐ **Step 4**: Entered business type, legal name, EIN, address, industry, website
- ☐ **Step 5**: Entered my personal details (and owners, if a company)
- ☐ **Step 6**: Set a clear statement descriptor and customer support info
- ☐ **Step 7**: Connected my business bank account and double-checked the numbers
- ☐ **Step 8**: Turned on two-step login and saved my backup code
- ☐ **Step 9**: Reviewed everything, clicked Agree and submit, and let Battle Labs know

"Stuck on any step? Take a photo or screenshot of your screen (cover any personal numbers) and text it to us. We'll walk you through it."